

Web Shell & File Navigation

Distinguish the URL from the real filesystem path and use the correct Linux/Windows commands through a web shell or RCE channel.

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Usage note: The web interface is only the access/execution channel. File commands come from the operating system running the application.

CHANNEL

Web / RCE

OS

Linux or Windows

PATH

URL ≠ filesystem

COMMANDS

Use OS commands

Contents

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1. URL ≠ Filesystem

This is one of the most common sources of confusion when working through a web shell.

A URL such as `http://target/uploads/shell.php` is not the filesystem path. The file might be `/var/www/html/uploads/shell.php`, `C:\inetpub\wwwroot\uploads\shell.aspx`, or somewhere else. Prove the path with `pwd/cd` or application context.

WEB SHELL — LINUX — Prove target context

```
whoami; pwd; uname -a
```

WEB SHELL — WINDOWS — Alternative

```
whoami & cd & ver
```

2. Browse Linux through a Web Shell

WEB SHELL — Identity and location

```
whoami; id; pwd
```

WEB SHELL — Files

```
ls -la  
find . -maxdepth 2 -type f 2>/dev/null
```

WEB SHELL — Read a file

```
cat ./file.txt  
head -n 30 ./file.txt
```

WEB SHELL — Common web-root clues

```
ls -la /var/www 2>/dev/null  
ls -la /var/www/html 2>/dev/null
```

Note: These are common paths, not guarantees.

3. Browse Windows through a Web Shell

WEB SHELL — Identity and location

```
whoami & cd & hostname
```

WEB SHELL — Files

```
dir /a  
dir /s /b *.config 2>nul
```

WEB SHELL — Read a file

```
type .\file.txt
```

WEB SHELL — Common IIS web-root clue

```
dir C:\inetpub\wwwroot 2>nul
```

Note: C:\inetpub\wwwroot is common for IIS, not guaranteed.

4. From Web Shell to Interactive Shell

A web shell may be stateless or may not provide a real TTY. Understand the channel before trying to make it interactive.

Type	Idea	Typical use
Command execution	Each request runs one command and returns output	Good for whoami/pwd and reading files.
Web shell	Web UI that executes commands	Working directory may not persist between requests.
Reverse shell	Target connects back to a listener	Provides a more interactive session in a lab.
Meterpreter	Metasploit session with extra capabilities	Different command set from the native OS shell.

If cd does not persist between web requests, use a compound command such as `cd /path && ls -la`.

5. Workflow

Do not start by uploading tools. Start by identifying the execution context.

LINUX

```
whoami; id; pwd; uname -a; ls -la
```

WINDOWS

```
whoami & cd & ver & dir /a
```

After identifying the OS, move to the Linux Essentials or Windows Essentials guide. If the authorized lab requires a more interactive channel, use the Reverse Shell & TTY guide.

Prepared as a quick-reference companion to the canonical Arabic guide. Use only in labs or systems you are explicitly authorized to test.

References:

Project: HTTP_HTTPS_Cheatsheet.html

Project: Linux/Windows Post-Exploitation references